

**THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS**

PMGM7012 Strategic Human Resource Management

GENERAL INFORMATION	
Instructor: Prof. Helen H. Zhao Email: hhzhao@hku.hk Office: 1317, KK Leung Building, The University of Hong Kong, Pok Fu Lam Phone: +852 39171640 Consultation times: By Appointment Teaching Assistant: LI Kongqi (Olivia) Email: kongqili@hku.hk Course Website: Moodle	
COURSE DESCRIPTION	
1. Strategic human resource management (HRM) aims to maximize the value of human capital with the design of hiring systems, performance systems, compensation systems, and organizational goal systems, etc. In this course, we focus on learning how to apply systems thinking tools, such as Behavior-Over-Time Graphs, Stock and Flow Mapping, and Causal Loop Diagrams, in designing and optimizing HRM systems in organizations. 2. This elective module is not only designed for HRM specialists but also for people who would like to build a happy and productive workforce.	
COURSE OBJECTIVES	
1. An overall understanding of the content topics in strategic HRM. 2. An update of exemplary people practices used by major corporations or promising startups. 3. An application of the design principles of important human capital systems. 4. A reflection of your own experience as a contributor and/or a manager.	
PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES	
PLO1. Acquisition and internalization of business knowledge and skills in key functional areas PLO2. Application of business knowledge to solve business problems PLO3. Development of managerial leadership and inculcating professional ethics and competency in business PLO4. Development of a global outlook PLO5. Mastering communication skills	
COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES	
Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1. Acquire a better understanding of the content topics	PLO 1, 4
CLO2. Apply concepts learned to analyze business scenarios	PLO 1, 2
CLO3. Develop skills in consulting, presentation, and teamwork	PLO 2, 5
CLO4. Facilitate communication between different backgrounds	PLO 4, 5

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES	
Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)
T&L1: Lecture	CLO 1 ,2, 4
T&L2: Simulation	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
T&L3: Group Presentation	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4

COURSE ASSESSMENT				
Assessment Methods		Brief Description	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1.	Team Presentation	Deliver an elevator pitch	30%	CLO1, 2, 3, 4
A2.	Individual Simulation	In-class simulation with quizzes, assignments, and competitive games.	40%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4
A3.	Class Attendance & Participation	Earn individual or group participation points	30%	CLO 2, 3, 4
		Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT		
Course Grade Descriptors		
Course Final Grade	Tentative Scores	Grade Descriptors
A+, A, A-	100-90%	The candidate shows an excellent understanding of the subject area, contributes to class discussion actively, receives an excellent score in the simulation, and/or delivers a powerful elevator pitch.
B+, B, B-	89-80%	The candidate shows a good understanding of the subject area, contributes to class discussion from time to time, receives a good score in the simulation, and/or delivers a good elevator pitch.
C+, C, C- or D+, D, D-	79-60%	The candidate shows an insufficient understanding of the subject area, contributes to class discussion in a minimal way, receives a fair score in the simulation, and/or delivers a fair elevator pitch.
F	<60%	The candidate does not understand most of the subject area, never contributes to class participation, receives a low score in the simulation, and/or delivers a poor team presentation.

TEAM PRESENTATION (150 points)

At the beginning of the course, you will have the option to form a cluster (typically with 6-7 people, but it depends on the final number of students, after the add-drop period), and then we will try our best to accommodate your preferences in the team assignment. Everybody in your team will receive the same score, but your score might be subject to an individual adjustment at the end of the semester. **Individual adjustments are topped at - 20%, and all adjustments will be completely evidence-based.** Individual adjustments aim to identify uneven contributions and reallocate the scores within your team. The best team should expect no individual adjustment. To aim that, you will be invited to take an online survey to let me know your experience with the team. This survey will be kept strictly confidential, and I will NOT discuss your responses with your teammates or any other parties without your approval. I might follow up with you if I would like to know further details about your responses. **Failure to complete the survey will result in a 10-point off from your individual grade.**

In your presentation, you are expected to identify a significant and well-justified people-related problem grounded in systems thinking. Since this is a strategic HR course, we define “people” broadly—you are not restricted to traditional HR topics as long as the issue involves people (i.e., intelligent agents). Your analysis should focus on ONE real company, supported by thorough research into its unique context. The proposed solution must be an original, specific, and actionable system intervention that directly addresses the identified problem. Vague or generic solutions—such as improving culture or adjusting incentives—will receive low marks. Instead, your intervention should be detailed enough for real-world implementation. Additionally, the solution should effectively resolve the problem without triggering unintended consequences. Be sure to apply systems thinking tools from class, including Causal Loop Diagrams (CLD) and Behavior Over Time Graphs (BOTG), to develop a system intervention.

During your presentation, each audience member will receive a grading sheet to evaluate whether, as the hypothetical CEO of the company, they would approve your proposed system intervention. This exercise is designed to create meaningful two-way communication - your goal is to actively engage your audience, capture their attention, and persuade them to endorse your solution. Approach this as a high-stakes elevator pitch where you must convince your classmates to say "YES" to your intervention. The more compelling and well-reasoned your proposal, the more approvals you're likely to receive! A detailed grading rubric will be posted to Moodle.

HR SIMULATION (200 points)

You will play an individual-based simulated game provided by a vendor at interpretive.com. The program office has purchased individual licenses for all enrolled students. In this simulation, each of you will assume the role of a Human Resource Director in a medium-sized company. You are dealing with a very challenging situation—its employees scored very badly in almost all company indicators, including performance, motivation, turnover, absenteeism, etc. Your job is to turn it around by making four quarterly decisions on staffing, compensation, training, programs, and a couple of incidents that may pop up from time to time. You have a limited budget.

150 out of 200 points are determined by your performance in the simulation game. 10 points are based on your performance on two short open-book quizzes. 40 points are based on your performance on four open-book assignments (each assignment is about one page). The quizzes and assignments are meant to help you better understand how the simulation works.

IN-CLASS PERFORMANCE (150 points)

Our lecture is highly interactive and we count on you to make our class a fun and rewarding learning experience. You can contribute to the class via three different ways.

Speak Up (75 points)

We encourage students to answer questions, ask questions, express opinions, and add evidence to in-class discussions. Each of the session will be graded separately and then add up together for an overall score of speak up. **If you speak up more than two times in one session, you will get a full speak-up score for this session.**

Mini Group Projects (75 points)

We conduct mini group projects during the lecture time, but we might not have time to do all the mini group projects stated on the lecture slides. You will be given around 15-20 minutes to work with your team to develop one slide for the assigned case. If you are ready to present on behalf of your team, please let us know and we will put your team number into a lottery system and randomly select two teams for presentation. Each of the presentation should last 3~5 minutes. **If your team is selected by lottery and you also do a reasonably good job in presenting, you will earn a “plus” for your team in this mini group project. For other teams who didn’t have a chance to present, we will grade your slide into “plus”, “check”, and “minus”, in which most of the teams should expect to receive “check” and “minus”.**

TEACHING SCHEDULE (tentative)

Session	Content
Sep 1	HRM as Systems
Sep 4	System Tools
Sep 8	HR Simulation Briefing; Quiz 1; Practice Run Opens
Sep 15	Performance System Design
Sep 22	Compensation System Design; Round 1&2 Simulation; Simulation Assignments Due
Sep 25	System Archetypes; Round 3&4 Simulation
Sep 29	System Intervention; Round 5&6 Simulation
Oct 2	Simulation Debriefing; Round 7&8 Simulation; Quiz 2
Oct 9	Entropy & Emergence in Complex Systems; Final Project Presentation

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

The Student Feedback on Teaching and Learning (SFTL) questionnaire is one of the ways HKU courses and teaching are evaluated. HKU places significant importance on student learning and on the continuous enhancement of teaching and learning outcomes. Students are asked to complete this evaluation of their learning experiences at the conclusion of each course in which they enrol. Questionnaire items relate to the overall evaluation of the course as well as an evaluation of teaching.

COURSE POLICY

The University Regulations on academic dishonesty will be strictly enforced. Please check the University Statement on Plagiarism on <https://tl.hku.hk/plagiarism/> .

Cheating or plagiarism of any kind would result in an automatic F grade for the course plus strict enforcement of all Faculty and/or University regulations regarding such behavior. Incident(s) of academic dishonesty will NOT be tolerated.

Academic dishonesty is a behavior in which a deliberately fraudulent misrepresentation is employed in an attempt to gain undeserved intellectual credit, either for oneself or for another. It includes, but is not necessarily limited to, the following types of cases:

- a. Plagiarism - the representation of someone else’s ideas as if they are one’s own. Where the arguments, data, designs, etc., of someone else are being used in a paper, report, oral presentation, or similar

academic project, this fact must be made explicitly clear by citing the appropriate references. The references must fully indicate the extent to which any parts of the project are not one's own work. Paraphrasing of someone else's ideas is still using someone else's ideas, and must be acknowledged.

- b. Unauthorized Collaboration on Out-of-Class Projects - the representation of work as solely one's own when in fact it is the result of a joint effort.
- c. Cheating on In-Class Exams - the covert gathering of information from other students, the use of unauthorized notes, unauthorized aids, etc.
- d. Unauthorized Advance Access to an Exam - the representation of materials prepared at leisure, as a result of unauthorized advance access (however obtained), as if it were prepared under the rigors of the exam setting. This misrepresentation is dishonest in itself even if there are not compounding factors, such as unauthorized uses of books or notes.

All assignments (i.e. individual papers) will be uploaded to Turnitin for originality checking and to identify potential plagiarism, if any.

Where a candidate for a degree or other award uses the work of another person or persons without due acknowledgement:

- 1. The relevant Board of Examiners may impose a penalty in relation to the seriousness of the offence.
- 2. The relevant Board of Examiners may report the candidate to the Senate, where there is *prima facie* evidence of an intention to deceive and where sanctions beyond those in (1) might be invoked.